Lesson 1: Home or not a home?

Foundation STEAM | Houses unit | 45 minutes | CRT-ready

Overview	
Focus	Homes come in lots of shapes and sizes, and every home keeps people safe, dry and comfy.
Curriculum	**VC2TDE2S01** Design and Technologies: how familiar products, services and environments are designed and produced by people to meet personal or local community needs.
Resources	Class set of the **Home or not a home?** cut-and-paste handout, scissors, glue sticks, **STEAM journals**, one set of **Design challenge cards** (last page) per table. One copy of the handout for the teacher to hold up during the class discussion.
Space	Mat area for the hook and discussion, then tables for cutting and pasting.

LISC

Learning Intention:

To learn that homes can look very different, but every home helps keep people safe, dry and comfy.

Success Criteria:

I can:

- sort pictures into homes and places that are not homes.
- say one thing that makes a place a home.
- tell how a home keeps people safe or dry.

Everything is ready for you

No preparation is needed. Everything is in the **labelled tub on the STEAM desk**: the handouts (one per student, plus one for you to hold up), the Design challenge cards already cut into sets, scissors and glue sticks. STEAM journals are in the class tub. Bring the class straight to the mat and start with the hook.

Lesson sequence

Time	What to do
0 to 5 min **Hook (CIC)**	**Mystery home riddle.** Read the riddle slowly, one clue at a time, and let students guess after each clue: *"People sleep in me every night. I have a kitchen and a bed. I have wheels, and a car can pull me to the beach."* When someone says caravan, point to the caravan on the handout. Ask: *"Is this a home? How do you know?"*
5 to 15 min **Talk about the pictures**	Point to each picture on the handout. Students show thumbs up (someone lives here) or thumbs down (nobody lives here). Ask one quick question per picture, for example *"Where would they sleep?"* or *"How would this keep the rain out?"* Then ask a tricky one with no picture: *"What about a hotel? People sleep there. Is it a home?"* Let partners talk, then share. Finish with the big idea, said together: **"Every home keeps people safe, dry and comfy."**
15 to 20 min **Model the journal**	Show students how to set up their STEAM journal: open to a new double page. The **tick label** (Someone lives here) is glued at the top of the left page. The **cross label** (Nobody lives here) is glued at the top of the right page. Model cutting out one picture, deciding which side it goes, and gluing it. While you model, choose one helper per table to put out scissors, glue sticks, journals and a set of Design challenge cards (face down).
20 to 38 min **Cut, sort, stick**	At tables, students write their name in their journal, then cut out the 2 labels and all 9 pictures. They **sort the pictures on the table first**, then glue them into their journal under the correct label. Walk around and ask each student: *"Why did you put this one here? What keeps the people dry?"* **Early finishers:** choose a Design challenge card. Read it to them, then they draw a home for that person on the next journal page and tell you about the feature that helps. Write a label for them if needed.
38 to 45 min **Share and reflect**	Choose 3 or 4 students to show their journal and explain one picture. Read the Success Criteria aloud and students show a thumb (up, sideways or down) for each one. Pack away scissors and glue, and collect journals.

The handout

One A4 sheet per student with 2 labels and 9 pictures to cut out. There are no words on the pictures, so students have to look and think to sort them.

Group	Pictures
Someone lives here (5)	Suburban house, apartment building, caravan, camping tent, house on stilts
Nobody lives here (4)	School, supermarket, bus, playground

Questions to ask

- Where would the people sleep?
- What keeps the rain and wind out?
- What is this home made of?
- Why would someone live up high on stilts? (to stay dry if the river floods)
- Why might someone choose a home with wheels?

What to look for

Success criterion	Evidence of learning
Sorts homes and not-homes	All 9 pictures glued under the correct label in the STEAM journal.
Says what makes a home	Uses words like sleep, live, safe, dry, warm, family when explaining a choice.
Tells how a home keeps people safe or dry	Points to a roof, walls, door or stilts and says what it does.

Design challenge cards

These are for students who finish the sort early and are ready to think like designers. Read the card aloud. A strong response is a home with a feature that matches the person's need.

Card	A home for...	Look for a feature like
Flood	Someone who lives next to a river that floods	Stilts, stairs up to the door, a house that floats
On the move	Someone who moves around a lot	Wheels, a tent that folds up, something light to carry
Very hot	Someone who lives somewhere very hot	Shade, a verandah, big windows for breeze, trees

Support and extension

Level	Idea
Support	Pre-cut the pictures for students who find cutting hard. Give the sentence starter: *"This is a home because people ___ here."*
Extension	Design challenge cards (see above). Students who finish a card can choose a second one.

Notes for the CRT

Sort before you stick. Foundation students glue fast, so remind them to lay every picture on the table under the right label before any glue comes out. **A dot, not a lot** of glue on the back of each picture. If time is short, skip the hotel question. Please leave the **STEAM journals** in the class tub on the STEAM desk. A short note about how the class went is always appreciated.

Design challenge: Flood

Design a home for someone who lives next to a river that floods. Draw it in your journal. What keeps them dry?

Design challenge: On the move

Design a home for someone who moves to a new place a lot. Draw it in your journal. How does the home move with them?

Design challenge: Very hot

Design a home for someone who lives somewhere very, very hot. Draw it in your journal. What keeps them cool?